

GE-122 Expository Writing
Credit Hours: 3 (3-0)
Pre-requisites: None
ENG-234: Expository Writing
Course Description

This course develops students' ability to write clear, organized, and effective expository texts for academic, professional, and real-world purposes. Through a project-based learning approach, students engage in practical writing tasks such as summaries, reports, CVs/resumés, cover letters, personal statements, and narrative expository stories. Emphasis is placed on the writing process, including planning, drafting, revising, and editing, to help students become confident, reflective, and purposeful communicators. Course themes encourage critical thinking, self-expression, and community awareness, fostering essential 21st-century skills in written communication.

Course Objectives

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- o Demonstrate understanding of the principles, types, and purposes of expository writing.
- o Apply the stages of the writing process — prewriting, drafting, revising, and editing — to produce clear, coherent, and grammatically accurate writing.
- o Write effectively for different audiences and purposes, including academic, professional, and community contexts.
- o Produce a range of expository documents such as summaries, reports, personal statements, CVs, and cover letters.
- o Use writing as a tool for self-reflection, critical analysis, and personal or professional development.

Learning Outcomes

- o Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:
- o Identify and apply the features of effective expository writing such as clarity, organization, coherence, and objectivity.
- o Plan, draft, revise, and proofread various types of expository texts, including essays, reports, and summaries.
- o Compose professional documents such as CVs/resumés, cover letters, and personal statements tailored to specific audiences and purposes.
- o Write reflective and narrative expository pieces that communicate real experiences and insights clearly and purposefully.
- o Edit and refine written work for grammatical accuracy, conciseness, and appropriate tone.
- o Present ideas and findings through written and oral communication that demonstrate critical thinking and effective collaboration.

Course Contents

Unit 1: Introduction to Expository Writing

- Understanding expository writing: definition, purpose, and key features
- Types and applications of expository writing in academic and professional contexts
- Characteristics of effective writing: clarity, coherence, and organization
- Distinguishing expository writing from other modes (narrative, descriptive, persuasive)

Unit 2: The Writing Process

- Prewriting strategies: brainstorming, freewriting, mind mapping, and outlining
- Drafting techniques: developing paragraphs and structuring essays
- Revising and editing: improving clarity, coherence, and grammar
- Proofreading for accuracy and conciseness
- Peer review and constructive feedback

Unit 3: Types of Expository Writing

- Description and illustration
- Classification and division
- Cause and effect (exploring relationships and outcomes)
- Process analysis (explaining step-by-step procedures)
- Comparison and contrast (analyzing similarities and differences)

Unit 4: Writing for Specific Purposes and Audiences

- Understanding purpose: to inform, analyze, persuade, or explain
- Writing for academic versus public audiences
- Adjusting tone, style, and formality for different contexts
- Incorporating evidence and examples effectively

Unit 5: Writing for Social Media

- Understanding the purpose and audience of social media writing
- Platforms and formats: posts, threads, captions, blogs, and microblogs
- Writing concisely and engagingly while maintaining clarity and professionalism
- Using tone, style, and voice appropriate to platform and audience
- Ethical considerations: accuracy, authenticity, and respectful communication
- Integrating multimedia (images, videos, links) to enhance messaging

Unit 5: Summary Writing

- Identifying main ideas and supporting details
- Paraphrasing and synthesis techniques
- Avoiding plagiarism and maintaining objectivity

- Writing concise, accurate, and well-structured summaries

Unit 6: CV / Résumé Writing

- Understanding the function and structure of a CV/résumé
- Organizing education, skills, experience, and achievements
- Writing effective bullet points using strong action verbs
- Formatting and designing for readability and professionalism

Unit 7: Cover Letter Writing

- Purpose and importance of a professional cover letter
- Structure: introduction, body, and closing paragraphs
- Connecting personal qualifications with position requirements
- Using a formal, confident, and concise writing style

Unit 8: Report Writing

- Components of a formal report: title, introduction, findings, conclusion, recommendations
- Writing with objectivity and clarity
- Presenting factual and analytical information logically
- Basic principles of formatting, citation, and referencing

Unit 9: Personal Statement Writing

- Purpose and audience of personal statements for academic or scholarship use
- Reflecting on experiences, goals, and achievements
- Developing an authentic and reflective writing voice
- Structuring and revising for impact, tone, and clarity

Unit 10: Story Writing (Narrative Exposition)

- Story writing as a reflective form of expository writing
- Elements of narrative exposition: setting, conflict, resolution, reflection
- Writing true or experience-based stories that communicate insight or personal growth
- Balancing creativity, structure, and clarity

SUGGESTED INSTRUCTIONAL/READING MATERIAL

- Writing Analytically by David Rosenwasser and Jill Stephen
- The Art of Styling Sentences by Ann Longknife K.D. Sullivan
- The St Martin's Guide to Writing by B Axelrod and Charles R Cooper
- Expository writing course outline- Sep 2021- HEC. Pdf
- Detailed courses expository writing Sep 2021 HEC.pdf
- Expository writing Teacher's Manual –sep 2021-HEC.pdfDomain: GE